MISS JOO WRITES

Notes on Becoming

July

A gentle reflection journal for anyone learning to move slower and trust what's unfolding.

2026

MONTHLY LETTER

Dear one,

July made me look at the woman I have been becoming between two worlds.

There is the life I came from - family, familiar language, ordinary traditions, and the comfort of being understood without explanation. Then there is the life I am building here in Qatar - responsibility, independence, quiet courage, and the small routines that have slowly become part of me.

I used to think missing home meant I had not learned how to belong here. Now I understand that the heart can carry longing and gratitude at the same time. Belonging does not require me to erase where I came from.

This month also reminded me that growth rarely arrives with an announcement. It appears in ordinary decisions, in the problems I solve alone, and in the moments I stop measuring my life against someone else's timeline.

This journal is for the woman who still feels unfinished. You are not behind. You do not need every answer before you begin. The woman you keep waiting to become has been present in every brave, quiet choice you have already made.

With love,

Miss Joo

THIS MONTH'S REFLECTIONS

Blog Recap & Highlights

1. Qatar Days Through a Filipina Woman's Eyes - July 2
2. The Things I Never Expected to Miss Until I Moved to Qatar - July 7
3. The Woman I'm Slowly Becoming - July 14
4. The Quiet Pressure to Have It All Figured Out - July 21
5. I Am No Longer Waiting to Become Her - July 29

QUOTES TO SIT WITH

> To be a Filipina woman in Qatar is to live between two worlds.
>
> Maybe home is also every place that changes you for the better.
>
> The changes that matter most rarely happen all at once. They happen quietly. One ordinary day at a time.
>
> Someone else's success does not mean I have failed. Their timing does not make mine wrong.
>
> Unfinished does not mean unready.

GUIDED REFLECTIONS

Reflections for This Month

REFLECTION 1

Living between two worlds

What parts of home do you still carry with you? What has the life you are building now added to the woman you are becoming?

REFLECTION 2

The ordinary things I miss

Name the small, everyday things you did not expect to miss. What feeling or memory does each one hold?

REFLECTION 3

Quiet proof of growth

What do you handle differently now than you did a year ago? List the changes that happened without applause or announcement.

REFLECTION 4

The timeline I was given

What did you believe you should have figured out by now? Which parts of that timeline are truly yours, and which came from comparison or expectation?

REFLECTION 5

Fill in the blanks

Home feels like _____ .

Living in Qatar has taught me _____ .

I am not behind because _____ .

The woman already here knows _____ .

CREATIVE ACTIVITY

Between Two Worlds

You do not have to choose one version of home. On the left, write what you carry from the Philippines. On the right, write what you are building in Qatar. In the space below, name who you are becoming between them.

WHAT I CARRY FROM HOME

WHAT I AM BUILDING HERE

WHO I AM BECOMING BETWEEN THEM

GRATITUDE & INTENTIONS

What I'm Grateful For

Three small comforts that made this month feel softer.

1

2

3

A quiet sign of growth I want to honor:

My intention for August:

"I do not need to chase the woman I am becoming.
I only need to stop leaving her behind."

NOTES ON BECOMING, JULY

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